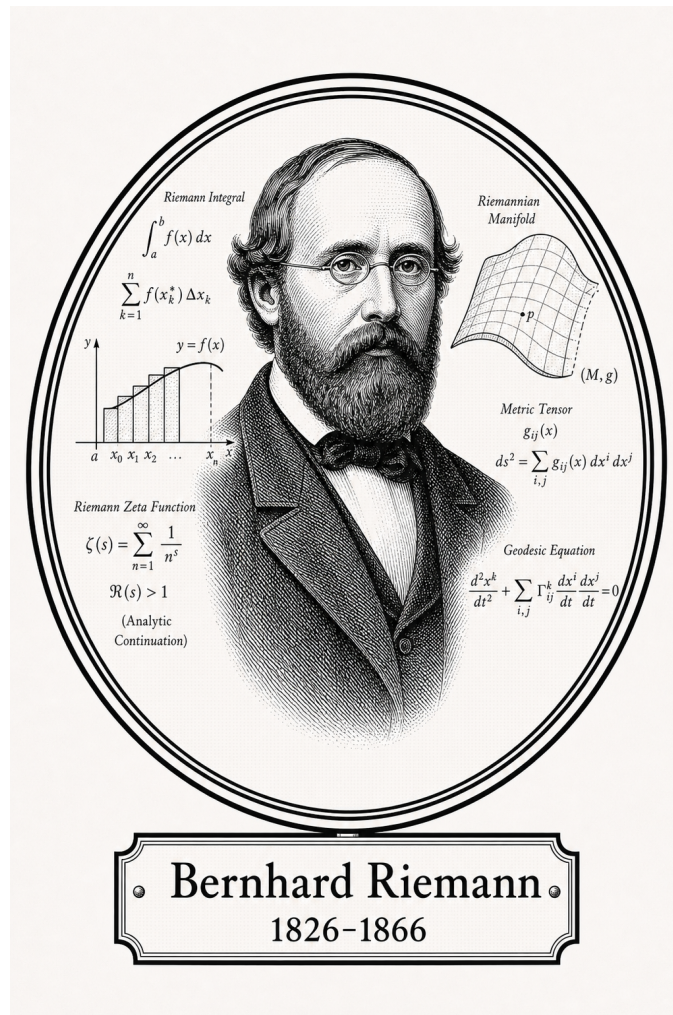


FROM CANTOR TO ITO

# Classical Analysis

## Integration



Bernhard Riemann

1826-1866

*Self-Study Notes*

William Sollers

June 29, 2026

*For every reader learning to make mathematics their own.*

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# Chapter 1

## Integration



### 1.1 Partitions and Tags

*Remark* (Reframing note). This chapter is the narrative version of the reference list. The reference orders the definitions correctly, but the real subject is the sequence of defects and patches:

geometric problem  $\rightarrow$  Cauchy  $\rightarrow$  Riemann  
 $\rightarrow$  Darboux  $\rightarrow$  Stieltjes  
 $\rightarrow$  Henstock–Kurzweil and McShane  
 $\rightarrow$  Lebesgue.

Each integral answers a concrete complaint about the one before it. The point is not to memorize several integrals, but to understand why each one had to be invented.

### The Geometric Problem

Forget integrals for a moment. The physical question is always the same:

Given a pointwise rate  $f$ , how much total quantity accumulates from  $a$  to  $b$ ?

A speedometer reads  $f(t)$ ; the accumulated quantity is distance. A wire has linear density  $f(x)$ ; the accumulated quantity is mass. A curve  $y = f(x)$  over  $[a, b]$  asks for signed area. The only available strategy is:

1. Chop  $[a, b]$  into thin slabs.
2. Pretend  $f$  is constant on each slab.
3. Add the resulting rectangles.

4. Refine the chopping and ask whether the sums settle.

Every construction below makes two choices: which height to use in a slab, and what it means for all these rectangle sums to settle to one number.

*Remark* (Construction comparison). The constructions differ by the height rule, the ruler, or the fineness rule:

| Construction      | Height rule                         | Ruler / fineness                  |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Cauchy            | $f(x_{i-1})$                        | $\Delta x_i$                      |
| Riemann           | $f(\xi_i)$                          | $\Delta x_i$                      |
| Darboux           | $\inf_I f, \sup_I f$                | $\Delta x_i$                      |
| Riemann–Stieltjes | $f(\xi_i)$                          | $\Delta \alpha_i$                 |
| Henstock–Kurzweil | $f(\xi_i), \xi_i \in I_i$           | $\Delta x_i, \delta(\xi_i)$ -fine |
| McShane           | $f(\xi_i), \xi_i \text{ may float}$ | $\Delta x_i, \delta(\xi_i)$ -fine |

Henstock–Kurzweil does not change the sampled height or the ordinary ruler; it changes the admissible chopping by replacing a global mesh bound with a local gauge condition. McShane keeps the same gauge idea but frees the tag from the slab, which pulls the theory back toward Lebesgue’s absolute notion of size.

#### Definition (Partition)

**Definition 1.1.1** (Partition of a Compact Interval). A *partition* of  $[a, b]$  is a finite increasing list

$$P = \{a = x_0 < x_1 < \cdots < x_n = b\}.$$

Equivalently,

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Partition}(P, a, b) \iff \exists n \in \mathbb{N} \exists x_0, \dots, x_n \in \mathbb{R} \\ (P = \{x_0, \dots, x_n\} \wedge x_0 = a \wedge x_n = b) \\ \wedge \forall i (1 \leq i \leq n \Rightarrow x_{i-1} < x_i). \end{aligned}$$

#### Definition (Subinterval Width)

**Definition 1.1.2** (Subinterval Width). The  $i$ -th slab has width

$$\Delta x_i = x_i - x_{i-1}.$$

#### Definition (Mesh)

**Definition 1.1.3** (Mesh of a Partition). The *mesh* or *norm* of  $P$  is the width of its fattest slab:

$$\|P\| = \max_{1 \leq i \leq n} \Delta x_i.$$

*Remark* (Geometric reading). The mesh is the resolution dial. The phrase “as the partition is refined” will usually mean that  $\|P\| \rightarrow 0$ : no slab is allowed to remain fat.

### Definition (Tagged Partition)

**Definition 1.1.4** (Tagged Partition). A *tagged partition* is a partition  $P = \{x_0, \dots, x_n\}$  together with points  $\xi_i \in [x_{i-1}, x_i]$ . The tag is the point where the height  $f(\xi_i)$  is sampled.

### Definition (Refinement)

**Definition 1.1.5** (Refinement of a Partition). A partition  $P'$  *refines*  $P$  when  $P \subseteq P'$ . Refinement adds cut-points; it does not move or delete existing cut-points.

### Lemma (Common Refinement)

**Lemma 1.1.6** (Common Refinement of Two Partitions). *Any two partitions  $P$  and  $P'$  of  $[a, b]$  have a common refinement: order the finite set  $P \cup P'$  increasingly.*

*Remark* (Why the lemma is load-bearing). This small fact is the reason independently chosen partitions can be compared. Whenever a proof says “refine them together,” it is using this lemma. It is the structural engine behind Cauchy’s existence proof and Darboux’s squeeze.

## 1.2 The Cauchy Integral

### Geometric Intuition

Cauchy makes the simplest possible height choice: always sample the left edge of each slab. The result is a staircase of left-anchored rectangles. As the slabs thin out, the question is whether those staircase areas settle.

*Remark* (Engineering reading). Cauchy’s construction is the seed. It answers the geometric problem for the case where the curve is tame enough that left-edge staircases forget their initial sampling bias as the mesh shrinks. The construction is deliberately primitive: it fixes a height rule first and asks for convergence second.

### Definition (Cauchy Sum)

**Definition 1.2.1** (Left-Endpoint Cauchy Sum). For  $f : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  and  $P = \{a = x_0 < \dots < x_n = b\}$ , define

$$C(f, P) = \sum_{i=1}^n f(x_{i-1}) \Delta x_i.$$

### Definition (Cauchy Integral)

**Definition 1.2.2** (Cauchy Integral). The function  $f$  is *Cauchy-integrable* with value  $L$  if

$$\forall \varepsilon > 0 \exists \delta > 0 \forall P (\|P\| < \delta \Rightarrow |C(f, P) - L| < \varepsilon).$$

The value  $L$  is denoted  $\int_a^b f(x) dx$ .

### Proposition (Integral of a Constant)

**Proposition 1.2.3** (Cauchy Integral of a Constant). *If  $f(x) = c$  on  $[a, b]$ , then  $\int_a^b c \, dx = c(b - a)$ .*

### Theorem (Linearity)

**Theorem 1.2.4** (Linearity of the Cauchy Integral). *If  $f$  and  $g$  are Cauchy-integrable on  $[a, b]$ , then*

$$\int_a^b (\alpha f + \beta g) \, dx = \alpha \int_a^b f \, dx + \beta \int_a^b g \, dx.$$

### Theorem (Monotonicity)

**Theorem 1.2.5** (Monotonicity of the Cauchy Integral). *If  $f$  and  $g$  are Cauchy-integrable on  $[a, b]$  and  $f(x) \leq g(x)$  for every  $x \in [a, b]$ , then*

$$\int_a^b f \, dx \leq \int_a^b g \, dx.$$

### Corollary (Bounds)

**Corollary 1.2.6** (Bounds for the Cauchy Integral). *If  $f$  is continuous on  $[a, b]$ ,  $m = \min_{[a,b]} f$ , and  $M = \max_{[a,b]} f$ , then*

$$m(b - a) \leq \int_a^b f \, dx \leq M(b - a).$$

### Theorem (Triangle Inequality)

**Theorem 1.2.7** (Triangle Inequality for the Cauchy Integral). *If  $f$  and  $|f|$  are Cauchy-integrable on  $[a, b]$ , then*

$$\left| \int_a^b f \, dx \right| \leq \int_a^b |f| \, dx.$$

### Theorem (Interval Additivity)

**Theorem 1.2.8** (Interval Additivity for the Cauchy Integral). *If  $c \in [a, b]$  and  $f$  is Cauchy-integrable on the relevant intervals, then*

$$\int_a^b f \, dx = \int_a^c f \, dx + \int_c^b f \, dx.$$



### Definition (Oscillation on an Interval)

**Definition 1.2.9** (Oscillation on an Interval). For bounded  $f$  on an interval  $I$ , define

$$\omega_f(I) = \sup_I f - \inf_I f.$$

Oscillation is the error controller: if  $\omega_f(I)$  is small, every sample height on  $I$  is close to every other sample height.

*Remark* (Oscillation as the visible error). Figure 1.1 shows the same quantity geometrically: the Darboux gap  $U(f, P) - L(f, P)$  is the sum of local oscillations  $\omega_f(I_i)$  multiplied by the slab widths  $\Delta x_i$ . The trapezoid and Simpson panels are numerical side branches; the load-bearing panel here is the oscillation identity.

## QUADRATURE & OSCILLATION

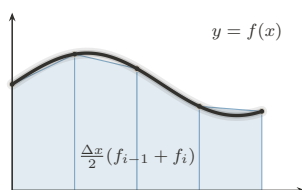


FIGURE 1. Trapezoid Rule:  
Chords: Exact for Affine  $f$

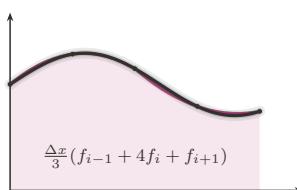


FIGURE 2. Simpson's Rule:  
Parabolas: Exact to Degree 3

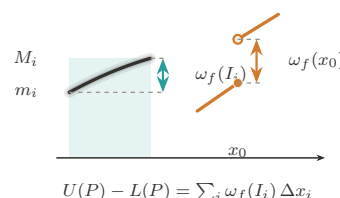


FIGURE 3. Oscillation:  
The Gap Generator  $\omega_f$

Figure 1.1: Quadrature and oscillation

### Theorem (Continuous Implies Cauchy-Integrable)

**Theorem 1.2.10** (Continuous Functions Are Cauchy-Integrable). *Every continuous function  $f : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  is Cauchy-integrable.*

*Remark* (Proof skeleton). Continuity on the compact interval gives uniform continuity. Hence short slabs have small oscillation. Given two fine partitions, pass to their common refinement and compare sums slab by slab; each re-sampling error is bounded by  $\omega_f(I)$  times the slab width. The sums form a Cauchy net, and completeness of  $\mathbb{R}$  supplies the limit.

*Remark* (What continuity buys). Uniform continuity is the load-bearing ingredient. It converts pointwise control into one global scale: if the slabs are all shorter than that scale, then every slab has small oscillation. Without this global scale, Cauchy's left-endpoint definition has no mechanism for proving that unrelated partitions settle to the same number.

*Remark* (A first discontinuous edge case). A single jump should still have an area. If

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} 0, & x < c, \\ 1, & x \geq c, \end{cases}$$

on  $[a, b]$ , the only dangerous slab is the one crossing  $c$ . Its total possible error is bounded by its width, and that width tends to zero as the mesh tends to zero. This example is not hard; the point is that Cauchy's definition gives no internal test explaining why it is harmless. The proof above proves continuity is sufficient, not that controlled discontinuities are allowed.

### Theorem (Tag Independence)

**Theorem 1.2.11** (Tag Independence for Continuous Functions). *If  $f$  is continuous on  $[a, b]$ , then every choice of tags gives the same limit as the left-endpoint sums as  $\|P\| \rightarrow 0$ .*

*Remark* (Bug report). Cauchy has two defects. First, the left endpoint is privileged by convention; tag independence is a theorem only after continuity has already been assumed. Second, the existence proof gives no usable criterion for discontinuous functions. The patch request is to stop privileging the left endpoint and make tag independence part of the definition.

*Remark* (Patch request). The next definition should not say “sample on the left.” It should say: sample anywhere, even adversarially, and require all fine enough choices to agree. Riemann is exactly Cauchy's tag-independence theorem promoted into the definition of integrability.

## 1.3 The Riemann Integral

### Geometric Intuition

Riemann promotes Cauchy's tag-independence theorem into a definition. A function is integrable when every sufficiently fine staircase, even with adversarial tags, is forced near the same number.

*Remark* (Engineering reading). The sampling convention is no longer chosen by the author of the definition. It is chosen by a universal quantifier. A Riemann-integrable function is one whose accumulated area survives every possible choice of sample heights once the slabs are fine enough.

### Definition (Riemann Sum)

**Definition 1.3.1** (Riemann Sum). For a tagged partition  $(P, \xi)$ , define

$$S(f, P, \xi) = \sum_{i=1}^n f(\xi_i) \Delta x_i.$$

### Definition (Riemann Integral)

**Definition 1.3.2** (Riemann Integral). A function  $f : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  is *Riemann-integrable* with value  $L$  if

$$\forall \varepsilon > 0 \exists \delta > 0 \forall (P, \xi) (\|P\| < \delta \Rightarrow |S(f, P, \xi) - L| < \varepsilon).$$

*Remark* (The one symbol that changed everything). Cauchy quantifies over choppings. Riemann quantifies over choppings and every possible choice of heights:

$$\forall P \quad \rightsquigarrow \quad \forall (P, \xi).$$

That extra quantifier removes the arbitrary left endpoint and turns tag independence into the price of admission.

*Remark* (Payoff). The definition is no longer tied to continuity. It can admit bounded functions with discontinuities, because the question is not whether  $f$  is continuous but whether all fine tagged sums are forced into one narrow numerical corridor. The Cauchy criterion below makes that statement intrinsic: the value need not be known in advance.

*Remark* (The ruler function example). Thomae's function, also called the ruler function, is

$$T(x) = \begin{cases} 1/q, & x = p/q \text{ in lowest terms,} \\ 0, & x \notin \mathbb{Q}. \end{cases}$$

It is discontinuous at every rational and continuous at every irrational, so its discontinuities are dense. Nevertheless its Riemann integral on any compact interval is 0. The reason is that the rational points where  $T$  can be large form only a finite set above any fixed height threshold. Fine partitions can isolate those finitely many tall spikes, while all remaining slabs have uniformly small height. This is exactly the kind of function Cauchy's continuity proof could not diagnose, but Riemann's tag-independent definition can admit.

#### Theorem (Continuous Implies Riemann-Integrable)

**Theorem 1.3.3** (Continuous Functions Are Riemann-Integrable). *Every continuous function  $f : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  is Riemann-integrable.*

#### Theorem (Linearity)

**Theorem 1.3.4** (Linearity of the Riemann Integral). *If  $f$  and  $g$  are Riemann-integrable on  $[a, b]$ , then*

$$\int_a^b (\alpha f + \beta g) dx = \alpha \int_a^b f dx + \beta \int_a^b g dx.$$

#### Theorem (Monotonicity)

**Theorem 1.3.5** (Monotonicity of the Riemann Integral). *If  $f$  and  $g$  are Riemann-integrable on  $[a, b]$  and  $f(x) \leq g(x)$  for every  $x \in [a, b]$ , then*

$$\int_a^b f dx \leq \int_a^b g dx.$$

### Theorem (Triangle Inequality)

**Theorem 1.3.6** (Triangle Inequality for the Riemann Integral). *If  $f$  is Riemann-integrable on  $[a, b]$ , then  $|f|$  is Riemann-integrable and*

$$\left| \int_a^b f \, dx \right| \leq \int_a^b |f| \, dx.$$

### Theorem (Interval Additivity)

**Theorem 1.3.7** (Interval Additivity for the Riemann Integral). *If  $c \in [a, b]$ , then  $f$  is Riemann-integrable on  $[a, b]$  if and only if it is Riemann-integrable on  $[a, c]$  and  $[c, b]$ , and in that case*

$$\int_a^b f \, dx = \int_a^c f \, dx + \int_c^b f \, dx.$$

### Theorem (Cauchy Criterion)

**Theorem 1.3.8** (Cauchy Criterion for Riemann Integrability). *A bounded function is Riemann-integrable if and only if for every  $\varepsilon > 0$  there is  $\delta > 0$  such that any two tagged partitions  $(P, \xi)$  and  $(Q, \eta)$  with  $\|P\|, \|Q\| < \delta$  have*

$$|S(f, P, \xi) - S(f, Q, \eta)| < \varepsilon.$$

*Remark* (Bug report). Riemann fixed the arbitrary tag, but the definition is operationally hostile. To verify integrability directly one must control all tagged partitions at once. The patch request is to remove tags from the verification problem: replace every possible sample height by the slab infimum and supremum, then squeeze.

*Remark* (Why this is hard to use). Riemann is logically clean but not mechanically friendly. Refining a partition does not make an arbitrary Riemann sum move monotonically, because every refinement lets the tags move again. There is no single upper or lower quantity improving under refinement. Darboux supplies exactly that missing monotone control.

## 1.4 The Darboux Integral

### Geometric Intuition

Darboux stops chasing tags. On each slab, the adversary can do no better than the supremum and no worse than the infimum. So build the upper staircase from  $\sup f$ , the lower staircase from  $\inf f$ , and ask whether the gap can be squeezed to zero.

*Remark* (Engineering reading). Darboux is the usable face of Riemann integration. It does not change the integral; it changes the test. Instead of quantifying over every possible tag, it brackets all tags at once.

### Definition (Darboux Sums)

**Definition 1.4.1** (Lower and Upper Darboux Sums). For bounded  $f$  on  $[a, b]$ , set

$$m_i = \inf_{[x_{i-1}, x_i]} f, \quad M_i = \sup_{[x_{i-1}, x_i]} f,$$

and define

$$L(f, P) = \sum_i m_i \Delta x_i, \quad U(f, P) = \sum_i M_i \Delta x_i.$$

### Lemma (Monotonicity Under Refinement)

**Lemma 1.4.2** (Darboux Sums Under Refinement). If  $P'$  refines  $P$ , then

$$L(f, P) \leq L(f, P') \leq U(f, P') \leq U(f, P).$$

*Remark* (Geometric reading). Thinner slabs give lower rectangles room to rise and upper rectangles room to fall. This monotonicity is exactly what Riemann sums lack when tags move adversarially.

*Remark* (One-point refinement proof idea). It is enough to add one cut-point  $c$  inside one slab and iterate. The infimum over the whole slab is less than or equal to the infimum over each piece, so the lower contribution rises. The supremum over the whole slab is greater than or equal to the supremum over each piece, so the upper contribution falls.

### Definition (Darboux Integrability)

**Definition 1.4.3** (Darboux Integrability). The lower and upper integrals are

$$\underline{I} = \sup_P L(f, P), \quad \bar{I} = \inf_P U(f, P).$$

The function  $f$  is *Darboux-integrable* if  $\underline{I} = \bar{I}$ .

### Theorem (Darboux Criterion)

**Theorem 1.4.4** (Darboux Criterion). A bounded function  $f$  is *Darboux-integrable* if and only if for every  $\varepsilon > 0$  there exists a partition  $P$  such that

$$U(f, P) - L(f, P) < \varepsilon.$$

*Remark* (The squeeze in one plate). Figure 1.2 places the Cauchy/Riemann tag choices, the lower–upper Darboux bracket, the refinement squeeze, and the gauge panel on the same page. The Darboux row is the chapter’s hinge: replacing moving tags by inf and sup turns integrability into the checkable  $U - L$  squeeze.

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## PROBES OF THE INTEGRAL

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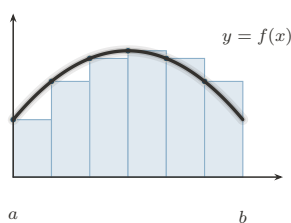


FIGURE 1. Left Riemann Sum:  
Tag at the Left Endpoint

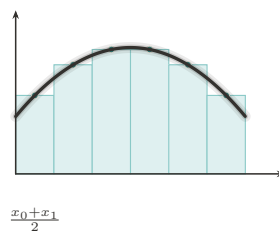


FIGURE 2. Midpoint Rule:  
The Centered Tag

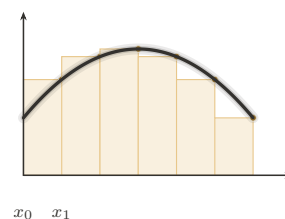


FIGURE 3. Right Riemann Sum:  
Tag at the Right Endpoint

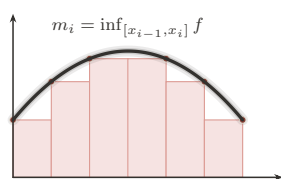


FIGURE 4. Lower Darboux Sum:  
The Infimum Probe

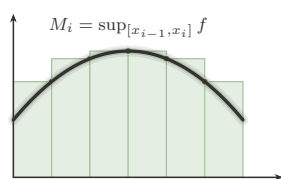


FIGURE 5. Upper Darboux Sum:  
The Supremum Probe

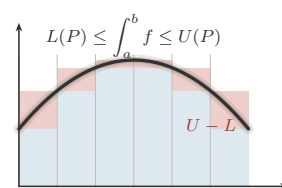


FIGURE 6. The Squeeze:  
Integrability as a Closing Gap

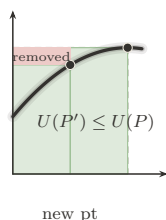


FIGURE 7. Partition Refinement:  
Adding Points Tightens the Sums

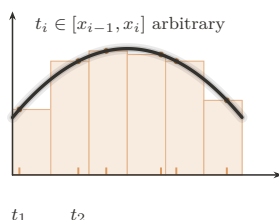


FIGURE 8. Tagged Partition:  
The General Riemann Sum

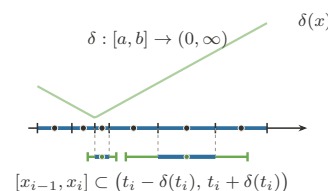


FIGURE 9. The Gauge:  
 $\delta$ -Fine Partitions (Henstock–Kurzweil)

Figure 1.2: Probes of the integral

### Theorem (Riemann Equals Darboux)

**Theorem 1.4.5** (Equivalence of Riemann and Darboux Integrability). *For bounded functions on  $[a, b]$ , Riemann integrability and Darboux integrability are equivalent, and the integral values agree.*

### Theorem (Continuous Functions Are Integrable)

**Theorem 1.4.6** (Continuous Functions Are Darboux-Integrable). *Every continuous function  $f : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  is Darboux-integrable.*

### Theorem (Monotone Functions Are Integrable)

**Theorem 1.4.7** (Monotone Functions Are Darboux-Integrable). *Every monotone function  $f : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  is Darboux-integrable.*

*Remark* (Why this is a harvest theorem). Monotone functions may have infinitely many discontinuities. Darboux still handles them because their total vertical movement is finite. On each slab the oscillation is just the endpoint jump across that slab, and these jumps telescope over the partition. Equal-width partitions therefore force  $U(f, P) - L(f, P)$  to zero.

### Theorem (Finitely Many Discontinuities)

**Theorem 1.4.8** (Bounded Functions with Finitely Many Discontinuities Are Darboux-Integrable). *If  $f : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  is bounded and has only finitely many discontinuities, then  $f$  is Darboux-integrable.*

*Remark* (Why finite bad sets are harmless). The Darboux gap is

$$U(f, P) - L(f, P) = \sum_i \omega_f([x_{i-1}, x_i]) \Delta x_i.$$

A finite set of discontinuities can be trapped in intervals of arbitrarily small total width. On the complement,  $f$  is continuous on compact pieces, so its oscillation is uniformly small on fine slabs. Thus the bad slabs are short and the good slabs are flat.

### Theorem (Algebra of Darboux-Integrable Functions)

**Theorem 1.4.9** (Sums and Scalar Multiples of Darboux-Integrable Functions). *If  $f$  and  $g$  are Darboux-integrable on  $[a, b]$ , then  $\alpha f + \beta g$  is Darboux-integrable for all  $\alpha, \beta \in \mathbb{R}$ .*

### Theorem (Products)

**Theorem 1.4.10** (Products of Darboux-Integrable Functions). *If  $f$  and  $g$  are Darboux-integrable on  $[a, b]$ , then  $fg$  is Darboux-integrable on  $[a, b]$ .*

### Theorem (Absolute Values)

**Theorem 1.4.11** (Absolute Values of Darboux-Integrable Functions). *If  $f$  is Darboux-integrable on  $[a, b]$ , then  $|f|$  is Darboux-integrable on  $[a, b]$ .*

### Theorem (Continuous Composition)

**Theorem 1.4.12** (Continuous Images of Darboux-Integrable Functions). *If  $f$  is Darboux-integrable on  $[a, b]$ ,  $\varphi$  is continuous on an interval containing  $f([a, b])$ , and  $f$  is bounded, then  $\varphi \circ f$  is Darboux-integrable on  $[a, b]$ .*

*Remark* (Why the harvest is cheap). The Darboux criterion reduces closure questions to controlling the upper-lower gap. Boundedness controls coefficients and products, while

continuity of  $\varphi$  converts small oscillation of  $f$  into small oscillation of  $\varphi \circ f$ . This is the point of switching from tags to a squeeze: theorems become estimates on  $U(f, P) - L(f, P)$ .

*Remark* (Bug report). Darboux is a better tool for the same class. It does not enlarge Riemann integrability. The remaining defects now fork. One can change the ruler  $\Delta x$  to  $\Delta \alpha$ , which leads to Riemann–Stieltjes. Or one can diagnose the size of the discontinuity set, which leads to Lebesgue and also to the gauge-integral cure.

*Remark* (Residual failures). The Dirichlet function  $\mathbf{1}_{\mathbb{Q}}$  on  $[0, 1]$  has infimum 0 and supremum 1 on every slab, since rationals and irrationals are dense. Thus  $L(f, P) = 0$  and  $U(f, P) = 1$  for every partition, so the Darboux gap never closes. This is not a Darboux-specific failure; by equivalence, it is the failure of the whole Riemann family. The failure modes in Figure 1.3 separate the common pathologies: Dirichlet breaks the continuity-almost-everywhere condition, Thomae survives it, unbounded examples violate the boundedness hypothesis, and pointwise limits show why Riemann integration has weak limit behavior.

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## WHERE RIEMANN FAILS

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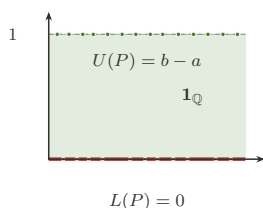


FIGURE 1. Dirichlet  $\mathbf{1}_{\mathbb{Q}}$ :  
The Gap That Never Closes

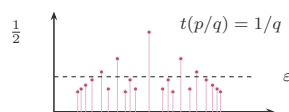


FIGURE 2. Thomae's Function:  
Dense Jumps, Yet Integrable

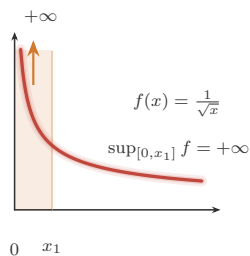


FIGURE 3. Unbounded Integrand:  
Boundedness Is Not Optional

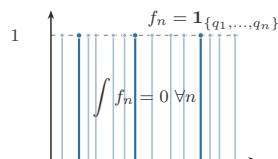


FIGURE 4. Pointwise Limit:  
 $\lim \int \neq \int \lim$  (Lebesgue's Cue)

Figure 1.3: Failure modes of the Riemann family

*Remark* (What Darboux makes visible). For Thomae's function, Darboux sees the opposite picture. On every slab the infimum is 0, because every slab contains irrationals. The supremum can be large only near rationals with small denominator; above any fixed height threshold, there are only finitely many such rationals. A partition can isolate those finitely



many tall rational spikes inside intervals of tiny total width, and the remaining upper rectangles are short. Thus the upper sum can be forced below any prescribed  $\varepsilon$ , while every lower sum is 0.

This is the practical gain: Riemann gives the correct definition, but Darboux gives the hand tool. Prove  $U - L$  can be squeezed, and the Riemann value follows from the equivalence theorem.

*Remark* (The fork). Darboux exposes two separate defects:

| Residual defect                | Successor         | Change                               |
|--------------------------------|-------------------|--------------------------------------|
| only ordinary length           | Riemann–Stieltjes | $\Delta x_i \mapsto \Delta \alpha_i$ |
| domain slabs see every bad set | Lebesgue / HK     | measure bad sets or adapt fineness   |

Stieltjes is therefore a sideways generalization, not the final repair of Riemann’s domain-partition limitation.

## 1.5 The Riemann–Stieltjes Integral

### Geometric Intuition

Riemann and Darboux weigh each slab by ordinary length,  $\Delta x_i$ . Riemann–Stieltjes changes the ruler. A slab is weighed by how much an integrator  $\alpha$  changes across it:

$$\Delta \alpha_i = \alpha(x_i) - \alpha(x_{i-1}).$$

If  $\alpha(x) = x$ , ordinary Riemann integration returns. If  $\alpha$  jumps, the integral sees a point mass.

*Remark* (Engineering reading). Stieltjes does not repair the discontinuity-set problem. It answers a different complaint: ordinary integration has only one ruler. By replacing  $\Delta x_i$  with  $\Delta \alpha_i$ , the integral can count regions with nonuniform weight and can encode discrete masses as jumps of  $\alpha$ .

#### Definition (Total Variation)

**Definition 1.5.1** (Total Variation). The total variation of  $\alpha$  on  $[a, b]$  is

$$V_a^b(\alpha) = \sup_P \sum_i |\alpha(x_i) - \alpha(x_{i-1})|.$$

#### Definition (Bounded Variation)

**Definition 1.5.2** (Bounded Variation). The function  $\alpha$  has *bounded variation* on  $[a, b]$  if

$$V_a^b(\alpha) < \infty.$$

Geometrically, this says the ruler has finite total up-and-down travel.

### Proposition (Monotone Implies BV)

**Proposition 1.5.3** (Monotone Functions Have Bounded Variation). *If  $\alpha$  is monotone on  $[a, b]$ , then  $\alpha$  has bounded variation.*

*Remark* (Why bounded variation is the honest ruler condition). If  $\alpha$  is increasing, the increments telescope:

$$\sum_i (\alpha(x_i) - \alpha(x_{i-1})) = \alpha(b) - \alpha(a).$$

Bounded variation is the signed analogue of that finite ruler budget. It is what prevents the weighted sums from accumulating uncontrolled oscillatory ruler error.

### Definition (Riemann–Stieltjes Integral)

**Definition 1.5.4** (Riemann–Stieltjes Integral). The Riemann–Stieltjes sum is

$$\sum_i f(\xi_i)(\alpha(x_i) - \alpha(x_{i-1})).$$

When these sums have a tag-independent limit as  $\|P\| \rightarrow 0$ , the limit is denoted  $\int_a^b f d\alpha$ .

### Theorem (Continuous Integrand, BV Integrator)

**Theorem 1.5.5** (Continuous Integrand and BV Integrator). *If  $f$  is continuous on  $[a, b]$  and  $\alpha$  has bounded variation, then  $\int_a^b f d\alpha$  exists.*

### Theorem (Bilinearity)

**Theorem 1.5.6** (Bilinearity of the Riemann–Stieltjes Integral). *Whenever the displayed integrals exist,*

$$\int_a^b (\lambda f + \mu g) d\alpha = \lambda \int_a^b f d\alpha + \mu \int_a^b g d\alpha$$

and

$$\int_a^b f d(\lambda\alpha + \mu\beta) = \lambda \int_a^b f d\alpha + \mu \int_a^b f d\beta.$$

### Theorem (Interval Additivity)

**Theorem 1.5.7** (Interval Additivity for the Riemann–Stieltjes Integral). *If  $c \in [a, b]$  and the relevant Riemann–Stieltjes integrals exist, then*

$$\int_a^b f d\alpha = \int_a^c f d\alpha + \int_c^b f d\alpha.$$

### Theorem (Integration by Parts)

**Theorem 1.5.8** (Riemann–Stieltjes Integration by Parts). *If  $f$  and  $\alpha$  are such that one of  $\int_a^b f d\alpha$  and  $\int_a^b \alpha df$  exists, then the other exists under the same Riemann–Stieltjes convention, and*

$$\int_a^b f d\alpha + \int_a^b \alpha df = f(b)\alpha(b) - f(a)\alpha(a).$$

### Theorem (Smooth Integrator Reduction)

**Theorem 1.5.9** (Reduction to Riemann Integration for a  $C^1$  Integrator). *If  $\alpha \in C^1([a, b])$  and  $f$  is Riemann-integrable on  $[a, b]$ , then*

$$\int_a^b f d\alpha = \int_a^b f(x)\alpha'(x) dx.$$

### Theorem (Step Integrator)

**Theorem 1.5.10** (Step Integrators Give Finite Sums). *If  $\alpha$  is constant except for finitely many jumps at points  $c_k$  and  $f$  is continuous at each  $c_k$ , then*

$$\int_a^b f d\alpha = \sum_k f(c_k) \Delta\alpha(c_k).$$

*Remark* (Proof idea). The Cauchy common-refinement argument runs again. Uniform continuity makes  $\omega_f(I)$  small on short slabs, and bounded variation controls  $\sum_i |\Delta\alpha_i|$ . The error has the form

$$\sum_i \omega_f(I_i) |\Delta\alpha_i|,$$

so small oscillation multiplied by finite total variation is small.

*Remark* (Sums as integrals). If  $\alpha$  is a step function with jumps at points  $c_k$ , then the Stieltjes integral collapses to a weighted sum of the values  $f(c_k)$  times the jumps. This is the conceptual doorway to probability: a cumulative distribution function is an integrator, and expectation is an integral against that integrator.

*Remark* (Step integrator calculation). Suppose  $\alpha$  is constant except for finitely many jumps  $\Delta\alpha(c_k) = \alpha(c_k+) - \alpha(c_k-)$ . Any sufficiently fine partition has one tiny slab around each  $c_k$  carrying that jump, while all other slabs have  $\Delta\alpha_i = 0$ . If  $f$  is continuous at each  $c_k$ , then the tagged height on the  $k$ -th jump slab is forced toward  $f(c_k)$ , so

$$\int_a^b f d\alpha = \sum_k f(c_k) \Delta\alpha(c_k).$$

This is why a finite weighted sum is not a different species from an integral: it is a Stieltjes integral against a discrete ruler.

*Remark* (Shared-jump failure). The new pathology is real. On  $[0, 1]$ , let  $c = 1/2$ , let

$$\alpha(x) = \mathbf{1}_{[c,1]}(x), \quad f(x) = \mathbf{1}_{[c,1]}(x).$$

The only nonzero  $\Delta\alpha_i$  occurs on the slab containing  $c$ . If the tag for that slab is chosen left of  $c$ , its contribution is 0; if the tag is chosen at or right of  $c$ , its contribution is 1. This discrepancy does not shrink with the slab width, because the ruler has a whole unit of mass concentrated at the jump. Tag independence fails, so the Riemann–Stieltjes integral does not exist in this convention.

*Remark* (Bug report). Stieltjes is a sideways generalization, not the Lebesgue fix. Shared discontinuities of  $f$  and  $\alpha$  can destroy tag independence, and the standard existence theorem leans on the finite ruler budget  $V_a^b(\alpha) < \infty$ . Brownian paths have infinite variation almost surely, so stochastic integration cannot be ordinary pathwise Riemann–Stieltjes integration.

*Remark* (Patch request). The next stochastic patch is not “make Stieltjes a little better.” Brownian motion forces a different limiting mode: an  $L^2$  or probabilistic limit rather than a pathwise Riemann–Stieltjes limit. That is the structural reason Ito integration is not just Stieltjes integration with a rougher integrator.

## 1.6 The Henstock–Kurzweil Integral

### Where This Sits

Darboux exposed the Riemann disease before measure theory names it precisely: one uniform fineness parameter must serve the whole interval. There are two ways forward. Lebesgue will change what is measured. The gauge integrals keep the tagged-sum picture and change exactly one symbol: the constant fineness  $\delta > 0$  becomes a positive function  $\delta(x)$ .

*Remark* (Sibling cure). Henstock–Kurzweil belongs here, before McShane and the final measure-zero diagnosis, because it is still visibly a Riemann-style tagged-sum integral. It patches the uniform-mesh defect without abandoning slabs, tags, or sums. McShane will modify the tag rule one more time, producing a gauge-sum version of Lebesgue integration.

### Geometric Intuition

A gauge is adaptive mesh refinement written as analysis. It is tiny where the function needs tight local control and generous where the function is calm. A tagged slab is allowed only if it fits inside the local radius prescribed by its own tag.

*Remark* (The one-symbol upgrade). Riemann uses a positive number:

$$\exists \delta > 0.$$

Henstock–Kurzweil uses a positive function:

$$\exists \delta : [a, b] \rightarrow (0, \infty).$$

The mesh condition  $\|P\| < \delta$  becomes the local condition that each slab is  $\delta$ -fine at its tag.

### Definition (Gauge)

**Definition 1.6.1** (Gauge on an Interval). A *gauge* on  $[a, b]$  is a function

$$\delta : [a, b] \rightarrow (0, \infty).$$

### Definition (Delta-Fine Tagged Partition)

**Definition 1.6.2** ( $\delta$ -Fine Tagged Partition). A tagged partition  $(P, \xi)$  is  $\delta$ -fine if

$$[x_{i-1}, x_i] \subset (\xi_i - \delta(\xi_i), \xi_i + \delta(\xi_i)) \quad \text{for every } i.$$

### Definition (Henstock–Kurzweil Integral)

**Definition 1.6.3** (Henstock–Kurzweil Integral). A function  $f : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  is *Henstock–Kurzweil integrable* with value  $A$  if

$$\forall \varepsilon > 0 \exists \delta : [a, b] \rightarrow (0, \infty) \forall (P, \xi) ((P, \xi) \text{ is } \delta\text{-fine} \Rightarrow |S(f, P, \xi) - A| < \varepsilon).$$

The value is denoted  $(\text{HK}) \int_a^b f$ .

### Lemma (Cousin)

**Lemma 1.6.4** (Cousin’s Lemma). *For every gauge  $\delta$  on  $[a, b]$ , there exists a  $\delta$ -fine tagged partition of  $[a, b]$ .*

*Remark* (Non-vacuity). Cousin’s Lemma prevents the definition from being empty. No matter how wildly the gauge varies, compactness of  $[a, b]$  guarantees that at least one tagged partition respects all the local step-size demands.

### Theorem (Riemann Sits Inside Henstock–Kurzweil)

**Theorem 1.6.5** (Riemann Integrable Implies Henstock–Kurzweil Integrable). *If  $f$  is Riemann-integrable on  $[a, b]$ , then  $f$  is Henstock–Kurzweil integrable on  $[a, b]$ , and the two integrals have the same value.*

*Remark* (Constant gauges). Riemann is the special case where the gauge is constant. If a Riemann proof hands over one mesh tolerance  $\delta_0$ , the gauge proof uses  $\delta(x) = \delta_0$  for every  $x$ .

### Lemma (Straddle)

**Lemma 1.6.6** (Straddle Lemma). *If  $F$  is differentiable at  $\xi$  with  $F'(\xi) = f(\xi)$ , then for every  $\varepsilon > 0$  there is  $\delta(\xi) > 0$  such that whenever  $u \leq \xi \leq v$ ,  $u, v \in (\xi - \delta(\xi), \xi + \delta(\xi))$ ,*

$$|F(v) - F(u) - f(\xi)(v - u)| \leq \varepsilon(v - u).$$

### Theorem (FTC for the Gauge Integral)

**Theorem 1.6.7** (Fundamental Theorem for the Henstock–Kurzweil Integral). *If  $F : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  is differentiable at every point and  $F' = f$ , then  $f$  is Henstock–Kurzweil integrable and*

$$(\text{HK}) \int_a^b f = F(b) - F(a).$$

### Theorem (Continuous Functions Are Henstock–Kurzweil Integrable)

**Theorem 1.6.8** (Continuous Functions Are Henstock–Kurzweil Integrable). *Every continuous function  $f : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  is Henstock–Kurzweil integrable.*

*Remark* (What it buys). On a compact interval,

$$\mathcal{R}[a, b] \subsetneq \mathcal{M}[a, b] = \mathcal{L}[a, b] \subsetneq \mathcal{HK}[a, b].$$

Figure 1.4 records this inclusion lattice and the standard witness at each frontier. The first strict inclusion is witnessed by functions like  $\mathbf{1}_{\mathbb{Q}}$ , which are Lebesgue-integrable but not Riemann integrable. The second is witnessed by derivatives such as that of  $F(x) = x^2 \sin(1/x^2)$  with  $F(0) = 0$ : the derivative is HK-integrable by the gauge FTC even when its absolute value is not Lebesgue-integrable.

This inclusion statement anticipates the next volume’s Lebesgue theory. The present chapter has not built Lebesgue integration yet; it has only isolated the Riemann-side machinery, the gauge machinery, and the reason a measure-theoretic successor is needed.

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# THE INTEGRATION LATTICE

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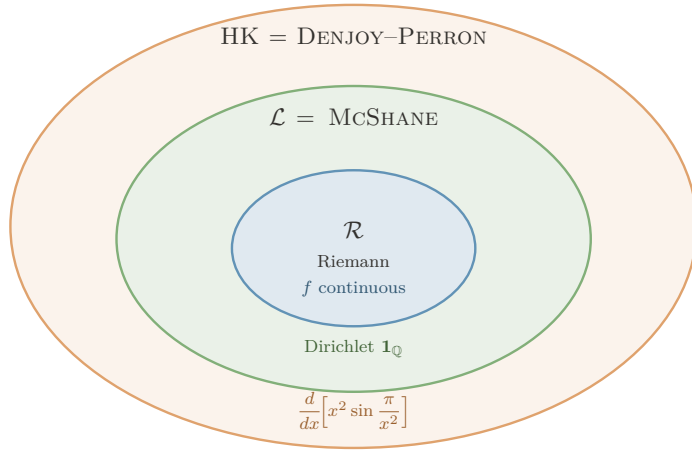


FIGURE. THE INTEGRATION LATTICE: EACH FRONTIER IS CROSSED BY EXACTLY ONE WITNESS.

$\mathcal{R} \subsetneq \mathcal{L} = \text{McShane} \subsetneq \mathcal{HK}$ , with the strict gaps witnessed by:

- $\mathcal{L} \setminus \mathcal{R}$ :  $\mathbf{1}_{\mathbb{Q}}$  — Lebesgue (and McShane) integrable,  $\int = 0$ ; not Riemann.
- $\mathcal{HK} \setminus \mathcal{L}$ :  $F'$  for  $F(x) = x^2 \sin(\pi/x^2)$ ,  $F(0) = 0$  — HK-integrable ( $\int_0^1 F' = F(1) - F(0) = 0$ ) but  $\int_0^1 |F'| = \infty$ , so not Lebesgue.

**Engine:**  $\mathcal{L} = \text{McShane}$  uses *free* tags (absolute integration);  $\mathcal{HK}$  uses *tethered* tags, which preserve cancellation — the source of the outermost ring, and the reason HK integrates *every* everywhere-derivative.

Figure 1.4: The inclusion lattice for Riemann, Lebesgue–McShane, and Henstock–Kurzweil integration

*Remark* (Killer example). Let  $F(x) = x^2 \sin(1/x^2)$  for  $x \neq 0$ , and set  $F(0) = 0$ . Then  $F$  is differentiable at 0, with  $F'(0) = 0$ , while for  $x \neq 0$ ,

$$F'(x) = 2x \sin(1/x^2) - \frac{2}{x} \cos(1/x^2).$$

The oscillatory term has nonintegrable absolute size near 0, so this derivative is the standard witness that HK reaches beyond Lebesgue while the FTC remains exact.

*Remark* (HK’s own bug report). Henstock–Kurzweil is not simply “the best integral.” Lebesgue has stronger limit theorems, a complete  $L^1$  normed-space home, and a clean abstract measure-space setting. HK is the jewel for the one-dimensional FTC and conditional accumulation; Lebesgue and Ito remain the engines for probability and stochastic integration.

*Remark* (Computational bridge). A gauge  $\delta(x)$  is a spatially varying step-size field. Lipschitz control is the case where a constant gauge is enough; singular or non-Lipschitz regions demand a genuinely varying gauge. Cousin’s Lemma is the compactness guarantee that a valid adaptive partition exists.

*Remark* (One-page summary).

| Integral          | Patch                                     | Remaining defect            |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Cauchy            | left rectangles settle for continuous $f$ | privileged tag              |
| Riemann           | all tags must agree                       | hard to verify              |
| Darboux           | sup/inf squeeze                           | same class as Riemann       |
| Stieltjes         | change the ruler                          | needs BV; shared jumps      |
| Henstock–Kurzweil | local gauge fineness                      | weaker limit machinery      |
| McShane           | free gauge tags                           | same class as Lebesgue      |
| Lebesgue          | measure level sets                        | abstract machinery required |

The thread is the right-hand column: every integral is a direct response to a specific defect.

## 1.7 The McShane Integral

### Where This Sits

McShane is the gauge integral that looks almost indistinguishable from Henstock–Kurzweil until one notices where the tags are allowed to live. HK keeps each tag inside its own slab. McShane lets a tag control a slab from outside it, as long as the slab lies inside the tag’s gauge ball.

*Remark* (The tiny syntactic change). Henstock–Kurzweil says:

$$\xi_i \in [x_{i-1}, x_i] \quad \text{and} \quad [x_{i-1}, x_i] \subset (\xi_i - \delta(\xi_i), \xi_i + \delta(\xi_i)).$$

McShane drops only the first requirement. The interval still has to be locally small around its tag, but the tag need not lie in the interval it controls. That small freedom is decisive: it prevents the conditional cancellation that lets HK integrate every derivative.

*Remark* (HK versus McShane at a glance).

| Integral          | Gauge       | Tag position                                                 | Class on $[a, b]$ |
|-------------------|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Henstock–Kurzweil | $\delta(x)$ | $\xi_i \in I_i$                                              | $\mathcal{HK}$    |
| McShane           | $\delta(x)$ | $\xi_i \in [a, b]$ and $I_i \subset B(\xi_i, \delta(\xi_i))$ | $\mathcal{L}$     |

Both use a variable gauge. The difference is not the step-size field; it is whether the tag must sit inside the interval whose height it supplies. Figure 1.5 shows this tethered-versus-free distinction directly.



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## TWO WAYS TO TAG

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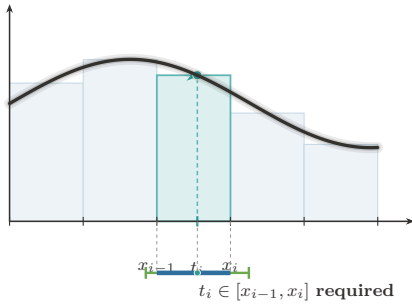


FIGURE 1. **Henstock–Kurzweil:**  
**Tag Tethered to Its Cell**

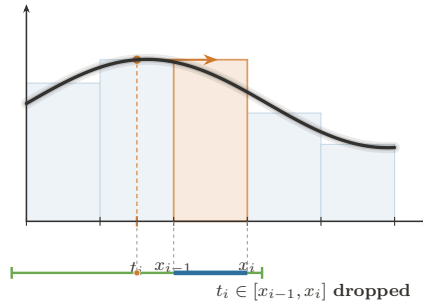


FIGURE 2. **McShane:**  
**The Tag Roams Free**

Same integrand, same gauge condition  $I_i \subseteq (t_i - \delta(t_i), t_i + \delta(t_i))$ . The *only* difference is whether the tag must sit in its own cell.

HK keeps the tether  $\Rightarrow$  conditional convergence survives  $\Rightarrow \mathcal{HK} = \text{Denjoy–Perron (nonabsolute)}$ .  
McSHANE cuts it  $\Rightarrow$  only absolute integrals remain  $\Rightarrow \text{McShane} = \mathcal{L}^1$  (Lebesgue).

Figure 1.5: Henstock–Kurzweil versus McShane fineness

## Geometric Intuition

In HK, a tag is a sample point inside the slab. In McShane, a tag is more like a local address that authorizes nearby slabs. The gauge still says how far the tag’s influence reaches, but the rectangle height may be chosen from a point near the slab rather than inside it. This makes the integral less forgiving about sign-changing singular behavior and much closer to Lebesgue’s absolute notion of size.

### Definition (McShane-Fine Tagged Partition)

**Definition 1.7.1** (McShane-Fine Tagged Partition). Let  $\delta : [a, b] \rightarrow (0, \infty)$  be a gauge. A finite tagged partition  $\{([u_i, v_i], \xi_i)\}_{i=1}^n$  is *McShane  $\delta$ -fine* if the intervals  $[u_i, v_i]$  are non-overlapping, cover  $[a, b]$ , each  $\xi_i \in [a, b]$ , and

$$[u_i, v_i] \subset (\xi_i - \delta(\xi_i), \xi_i + \delta(\xi_i)) \quad \text{for every } i.$$

Unlike an HK tagged partition, the tag  $\xi_i$  is not required to lie in  $[u_i, v_i]$ .

*Remark* (Untethered tag). Figure 1.6 isolates the McShane move: a tag may sit outside the cell whose height it supplies, provided the cell lies inside the tag’s gauge ball. The ruler is still  $\Delta x_i$ ; the change is entirely in the admissible tag geometry.

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# THE MCSHANE INTEGRAL

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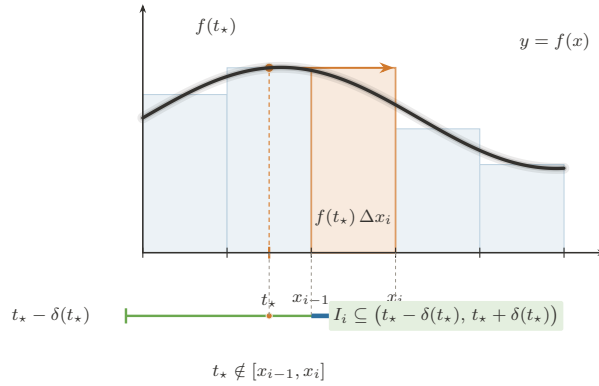


FIGURE. THE MCSHANE INTEGRAL — THE UNTETHERED TAG: A  $\delta$ -FINE PARTITION  
WHOSE TAGS ROAM FREE.

**Rule (the only change from Henstock–Kurzweil).** A tagged partition is *McShane  $\delta$ -fine* iff  $\forall i (I_i \subseteq (t_i - \delta(t_i), t_i + \delta(t_i)))$ , with tags  $t_i \in [a, b]$  arbitrary — the clause  $t_i \in I_i$  is dropped. The sum is still  $S = \sum_i f(t_i) \Delta x_i$ , and

$$f \text{ McShane integrable} \iff f \in L^1[a, b], \quad \text{with equal values.}$$

**Where it sits:**  $\mathcal{R} \subsetneq \mathcal{L} = \text{McShane} \subsetneq \mathcal{HK}$  (Riemann  $\subsetneq$  Lebesgue = McShane  $\subsetneq$  Henstock–Kurzweil).

Figure 1.6: The McShane integral and the untethered tag

## Definition (McShane Integral)

**Definition 1.7.2** (McShane Integral). A function  $f : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  is *McShane integrable* with value  $A$  if

$$\forall \varepsilon > 0 \exists \delta : [a, b] \rightarrow (0, \infty) \forall (P, \xi) ((P, \xi) \text{ is McShane } \delta\text{-fine} \Rightarrow |S(f, P, \xi) - A| < \varepsilon),$$

where

$$S(f, P, \xi) = \sum_i f(\xi_i)(v_i - u_i).$$

*Remark* (Relation to HK). Every McShane-fine partition is not necessarily HK-fine, because its tags may float outside their intervals. But every HK-fine partition is McShane-fine. Therefore McShane integrability is a stronger demand: the sums must survive all the usual gauge-fine tests and also the extra free-tag tests.

### Theorem (McShane Sits Between Riemann and HK)

**Theorem 1.7.3** (Riemann Integrable Implies McShane Integrable Implies Henstock–Kurzweil Integrable). *On a compact interval,*

$$\mathcal{R}[a, b] \subseteq \mathcal{M}[a, b] \subseteq \mathcal{HK}[a, b],$$

*and the integral values agree whenever a function belongs to the smaller class.*

*Remark* (The Lebesgue connection). For real-valued functions on a compact interval, the McShane integral recovers the Lebesgue integral. In practical terms,

$$\mathcal{M}[a, b] = \mathcal{L}[a, b]$$

with equal values. Thus McShane is not a second route beyond Lebesgue in the way HK is. It is a gauge-sum presentation of Lebesgue integration.

*Remark* (Forward dependency). The proof that every Riemann-integrable function is McShane-integrable uses the measure-zero diagnosis in the next section: Riemann integrability means the discontinuity set is null. The exposition places McShane first because it belongs syntactically with the gauge integrals; the proof ledger records that it imports the Lebesgue criterion.

*Remark* (Why free tags force Lebesgue behavior). The HK derivative example

$$F'(x) = 2x \sin(1/x^2) - \frac{2}{x} \cos(1/x^2)$$

is conditionally integrable by HK because the tags remain inside the tiny slabs where the derivative is being locally linearized. McShane’s free tags can sample nearby oscillatory peaks in a way that destroys this conditional balance. What survives that stronger test is exactly the Lebesgue-integrable, absolutely controlled part of the gauge world.

*Remark* (What it buys). McShane gives a tagged-sum construction of the Lebesgue integral without starting from simple functions or sigma-algebras. Conceptually, that is its job in this chapter: it shows that adaptive Riemann-style sums can reach the Lebesgue class, while HK shows that keeping tags inside slabs reaches beyond Lebesgue to conditionally integrable derivatives.

*Remark* (Bug report). McShane is elegant but not the terminal fix for this chapter’s story. If one wants a tagged-sum definition of the Lebesgue integral, it is excellent. If one wants the perfect one-dimensional Fundamental Theorem of Calculus, HK is strictly stronger. And if one wants probability, stochastic processes, and abstract spaces, the next volume still needs measure theory explicitly.

*Remark* (Handoff to measure zero). McShane reveals that gauge machinery and Lebesgue size are compatible. The next section names the exact size condition already controlling the older Riemann–Darboux family: the discontinuity set must have measure zero.

## 1.8 Measure Zero and the Lebesgue Criterion

### Geometric Intuition

Darboux integrability fails where upper and lower staircases refuse to meet. That refusal is local oscillation. Thus the exact Riemann question becomes: how large is the set where  $f$  is discontinuous?

*Remark* (Engineering reading). This final section is not another integral. It is the diagnostic scan of the entire Riemann–Darboux family, placed after Henstock–Kurzweil and McShane so the chapter ends by naming the exact obstruction that opens the Lebesgue volume. Once Darboux has made the gap visible, the remaining question is whether the bad part of the domain is small enough to cover by slabs of negligible total length.

#### Definition (Measure Zero)

**Definition 1.8.1** (Measure Zero). A set  $E \subseteq \mathbb{R}$  has *measure zero* if for every  $\varepsilon > 0$  there are open intervals  $I_k$  such that

$$E \subseteq \bigcup_{k=1}^{\infty} I_k, \quad \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} |I_k| < \varepsilon.$$

#### Definition (Point Oscillation)

**Definition 1.8.2** (Point Oscillation). For bounded  $f$  on  $[a, b]$ , define

$$\omega_f(x) = \inf_{\delta > 0} \omega_f((x - \delta, x + \delta) \cap [a, b]).$$

Then  $f$  is continuous at  $x$  exactly when  $\omega_f(x) = 0$ .

*Remark* (Oscillation levels). The sets

$$D_\eta = \{x : \omega_f(x) \geq \eta\}$$

separate the bad set by severity. The full discontinuity set is

$$D = \bigcup_{k=1}^{\infty} D_{1/k}.$$

The proof of the criterion works by showing that positive-size high oscillation forces a permanent Darboux gap, while null high-oscillation sets can be covered by intervals of tiny total length.

### Theorem (Lebesgue Criterion)

**Theorem 1.8.3** (Lebesgue Criterion for Riemann Integrability). *A bounded function  $f : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  is Riemann-integrable if and only if its discontinuity set*

$$D = \{x \in [a, b] : \omega_f(x) > 0\}$$

*has measure zero.*

*Remark* (Terminal diagnosis). Riemann integration works precisely when the set of bad points is invisible to length. The Dirichlet function  $\mathbf{1}_{\mathbb{Q}}$  is discontinuous everywhere, so  $D = [0, 1]$ , not a null set. The Lebesgue patch is to stop partitioning the domain into slabs and instead measure the sets where the function takes given ranges of values. Henstock–Kurzweil keeps tagged sums, but replaces uniform fineness by local fineness; McShane shows that a slightly stricter gauge rule recovers the Lebesgue class itself. The pathology plate in Figure 1.3 is the visual companion to this diagnosis.

*Remark* (Lebesgue handoff). The slogan is precise: Riemann partitions the domain, so every slab that meets a dense bad set still sees the bad behavior. Lebesgue partitions the range: it groups points by height and measures the set carrying each height. For  $\mathbf{1}_{\mathbb{Q}}$ , the height 1 lives on a null set and therefore contributes nothing.

## Appendix: Pathologies of the Riemann Integral

*Remark* (Source placement). This appendix is the converted support note from `integration-failures.tex`. Its standalone theorem machinery and document preamble have been removed; the material is kept as commentary so it does not duplicate the formal Lebesgue criterion in Section 1.8.3.

*Remark* (The one theorem behind the failures). The Riemann failures in Figure 1.3 are not a bag of examples. They are tests against the two hypotheses in the Lebesgue criterion: boundedness, and a discontinuity set of measure zero. Dirichlet fails because its discontinuity set is all of  $[0, 1]$ . Unbounded examples fail before the criterion even begins. Pointwise limits expose a different weakness: the Riemann class is not stable under the limit operations that Lebesgue integration was built to support.

*Remark* (Thomae as the diagnostic example). Thomae’s function is the useful warning. Its discontinuities are dense, but they are countable and therefore null. Darboux can isolate the finitely many large spikes above any fixed threshold inside intervals of tiny total length; outside those intervals, the upper sums are uniformly small. Thus density of the bad set is not the obstruction. Size is.

*Remark* (Through-line). The atlas failure note should be read as the bridge from Darboux to Measure Zero:  $U(f, P) - L(f, P)$  is local oscillation times length, so the only bad oscillation that matters is bad oscillation carried by a set of positive length. That observation closes the Riemann family and points directly to Lebesgue’s range-partition construction.

## Appendix: The Gauge Integrals

*Remark* (Source placement). This appendix is the converted support note from `gauge-integrals.tex`. The standalone preamble, local theorem declarations, and duplicate figure includes have been removed; the shared figures are the pinned figures already included in Sections 1.6 and 1.7.

*Remark* (The gauge framework). The gauge integrals replace Riemann’s single global mesh tolerance by a local step-size controller  $\delta : [a, b] \rightarrow (0, \infty)$ . Henstock–Kurzweil and McShane then differ by one geometric clause. HK requires the tag to sit inside the interval it controls. McShane drops that tether and allows the tag to range over  $[a, b]$ , provided the interval lies inside the tag’s gauge ball. The contrast is visualized in Figures 1.5 and 1.6.

*Remark* (Free tags and Lebesgue). McShane’s free tags force absolute, Lebesgue-style behavior. Since a tag can authorize nearby intervals without lying inside them, the sums can test whether the mass assigned to height bands is genuinely controlled. On compact intervals this recovers the Lebesgue integral:  $\mathcal{M}[a, b] = \mathcal{L}[a, b]$ , with equal values.

*Remark* (Tethered tags and the FTC). HK keeps the tag tethered to its interval, which preserves local cancellation for derivatives. That is why the HK integral has the exact one-dimensional FTC: if  $F$  is differentiable everywhere, then  $F'$  is HK-integrable and  $(\text{HK}) \int_a^b F' = F(b) - F(a)$ , even when  $F'$  is not Lebesgue integrable.

*Remark* (Lattice). The resulting compact-interval lattice is

$$\mathcal{R}[a, b] \subsetneq \mathcal{L}[a, b] = \mathcal{M}[a, b] \subsetneq \mathcal{HK}[a, b],$$

as recorded in Figure 1.4. This appendix is kept after the main chapter because the book has not yet built the measure theory needed to prove the McShane–Lebesgue identification.

# Bibliography